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I5. National Certifications

France Compétences (France Skills, in English) is the arm of the French government charged with funding and regulating vocational training and apprenticeship programmes in the country. An important part of its role is to maintain official directories of certified programmes (that is, those vocational programmes that are officially recognised and certified by the French government).

There are two principal directories to consult to **ensure that a vocational programme is duly certified**.

First, the *Répertoire national des certifications professionnelles* (RNCP) (or, in English, the National Directory of Professional Certifications) and also the *Répertoire spécifique* (RS) *des certifications et des habilitations*, which records certified programmes in various specialisations and sub-specialisations.

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